

On the *Digit* forum, the majority of members (about 60 per cent) fall into this category. Most members of this category look towards developing their technology skills, and also help those in need of answers. It is these members that contribute most towards the growth in popularity of a forum, and word generally spreads through them.

Needless to say, it is vital that the majority of forum members fall into this category for a forum to become successful or popular. A shift in balance towards any other category will spell certain doom for any forum.

Addicts

It's hard to start anything online today without getting a few thousand people addicted, and forums are no exception. There are always a group of people who can derive enough fun out of absolutely anything to get permanently hooked.

Of the *Digit* forum population, roughly 10 per cent fall in this category. These are people who post several times a day—as many as a thousand posts by a single member in two weeks on our forum! Such folks look forward to getting home and on the forum as much as some people need coffee or tea every morning.

It may seem that these members contribute the most to a forum, and thus are perhaps significantly responsible for its growth, but in truth, it is the other way round. Forum addicts so badly need to post their views that they sometimes do not care whether their views will be appreciated.

On our forum, for example, forum addicts are not necessarily the most technologically sound members, and often end up making frivolous posts about inane topics that only make other members cry out in disbelief. Often, such posts lead to heated discussions and name-calling.